

σ -Additive Probability on Orthomodular Lattices: A Survey and an Open Problem

Patrick S. Mahon

Survey note — June 2026

Abstract

The passage from a finitely coherent assignment of probabilities to a countably additive measure is, in the Boolean case, governed by a single condition (countable additivity) and executed by classical machinery (Carathéodory; Loomis–Sikorski; Stone duality). On a *non-distributive* orthomodular lattice (OML) — the algebra of propositions of a quantum system — this machinery breaks, and the question of when finite coherence forces countable behaviour is open. We survey the problem at the level needed to begin work on it. After fixing the apparatus (orthomodular lattices, the gap between orthogonality and meet-zero, the state/meet-additive/charge ladder, the McDonald–Bimbó dual space), we separate the question into two axes. The *extension* axis is classical (Horn–Tarski feasibility) and fully settled: on $L(H)$ no state of any kind extends, by an elementary finite construction; the *descent* axis is genuinely open and rests on a representation that does not exist: a Loomis–Sikorski theorem for σ -complete OMLs. The stake is more than technical: such a representation would furnish a *point-free*, σ -additive probability theory on a non-distributive lattice — the non-Boolean analogue of localic measure theory — built from the entailment relation rather than descended from a sample space. We review what is known and what is ruled out, and close with the two directions in which the open problem might be approached.

1 Introduction

All measurement is finite, yet the frameworks that organise empirical knowledge — probability theory, quantum mechanics — rest on infinite structures. The passage from finite observation to infinite structure is not automatic; it requires a commitment no finite body of evidence can compel. In probability theory the locus of that commitment is *countable additivity*:

$$A_1 \supseteq A_2 \supseteq \cdots, \quad \bigcap_n A_n = \emptyset \quad \implies \quad \mu(A_n) \rightarrow 0.$$

De Finetti [7] held that only finite additivity is empirically grounded; Kolmogorov [23] adopted σ -additivity as an axiom.

The same tension recurs once observations need not be jointly performable. An observation *context* — a set of measurements performable together — is Boolean; gluing contexts along shared observations (a categorical colimit) returns:

contexts mutually compatible $\Rightarrow$ Boolean algebra, incompatible $\Rightarrow$ non-distributive OML

(Gunji et al. [16]; the dichotomy organises the companion paper [24]). The OML is *forced* by the context structure, not postulated. Incompatibility — quantum complementarity, but equally contextual experimental design or interfering sensors — drives the algebra out of the Boolean world. One caveat fixes the scope: for non-quantum examples the incompatibility must be *operationally imposed* (contexts genuinely non-co-realizable, no joint probability space); it cannot arise intrinsically from one classical system’s dynamics, since any finite family of

classical observables on a common space jointly distributes (Kolmogorov), hence stays Boolean — contextuality there is failure of a global section (Abramsky–Brandenburger [1]; Fine [11]). The closed subspaces of a Hilbert space H form the prototype $L(H)$, not the premise.

On a non-distributive OML, Carathéodory’s outer measure — needing a Boolean algebra of sets — does not apply, and the rescue is local to $L(H)$:

- For $L(H)$, Gleason’s rigidity theorem [14] rescues it; Hilbert space is special and no general-OML analogue is known.
- Non-distributivity *per se* does not remove the 2-valued homomorphisms the Boolean engine needs — MO_3 is non-distributive yet carries them (§2.1, §4) — but it removes the *guarantee*; for $L(H)$, $\dim \geq 3$ they fail outright (Kochen–Specker [22]).

Whether enough survive is a question of concreteness, not non-distributivity — the qualifier on which the open problem turns (§4, §5).

The organising split. This note asks the shared question — *when does finite coherence force countable behaviour?* — on an OML. The vague question splits into two axes that the Boolean case fuses, and the survey is built around the split:

Axis	Asks	Status
Extension	does a state extend to a charge on $S_0(A)$?	settled (on $L(H)$, <i>none</i> does)
Descent	does the charge concentrate on physical points?	open

The relational standpoint. Two established moves motivate the approach:

- De Finetti [7] — probability without a presupposed sample space: coherent commitments about events, not measures on a given Ω .
- Birkhoff–von Neumann — propositions as a lattice (the OML of §2), not as subsets of a phase space.

Combining them, we start from the propositions and their entailment order and ask what that relational structure alone determines — the measure-theoretic counterpart of pointless (localic) topology. The dual is then not a space of points but the McDonald–Bimbó space of *filters* (§2.3), and a positive answer to the open problem would be a *point-free* σ -additive probability theory on a non-distributive lattice — the non-Boolean analogue of localic measure theory (§5; developed further in [25]).

2 Preliminaries

We collect the lattice-theoretic apparatus; all notions are standard.

2.1 Orthomodular lattices, and the orthogonal/meet-zero gap

Definition 2.1 (Orthocomplemented lattice). A *bounded lattice* is a partially ordered set in which every pair a, b has a join $a \vee b$ and meet $a \wedge b$, with greatest element **1** and least element **0**. An *orthocomplementation* is a map $a \mapsto a^\perp$ satisfying, for all a, b :

- (i) $a \wedge a^\perp = \mathbf{0}$ and $a \vee a^\perp = \mathbf{1}$ (complement),
- (ii) $a^{\perp\perp} = a$ (involution),
- (iii) $a \leq b \Rightarrow b^\perp \leq a^\perp$ (order-reversing).

Definition 2.2 (Orthogonal; meet-zero). Elements a, b are *orthogonal*, written $a \perp b$, if $a \leq b^\perp$ (equivalently $b \leq a^\perp$) — one entails the other’s negation, *decisively incompatible*. They are *meet-zero* if $a \wedge b = \mathbf{0}$ — no common refinement, a weaker condition.

The gap. Orthogonality always implies meet-zero; the converse holds in every Boolean algebra but **fails** once the lattice is non-distributive. *Meet-zero is strictly weaker than orthogonal* — the distinctions developed below all turn on this.

Definition 2.3 (Orthomodular lattice). An orthocomplemented lattice A is *orthomodular* if

$$a \leq b \implies b = a \vee (a^\perp \wedge b). \quad (1)$$

A *Boolean algebra* is the special case where $\wedge$ distributes over $\vee$; every Boolean algebra is orthomodular, not conversely. The motivating non-Boolean example is $L(H)$, the closed subspaces of a Hilbert space with $a^\perp$ the orthogonal complement.

Example 2.4 (MO_n , and the gap made concrete). MO_n is the lattice with $\mathbf{0}$, $\mathbf{1}$, and n complementary pairs of incomparable atoms, all sharing only $\mathbf{0}$ and $\mathbf{1}$. *Picture n lines through the origin: each line a is $\perp$ to its perpendicular $a^\perp$, but two atoms from distinct pairs are non-perpendicular lines.* It is orthomodular and non-distributive ($n \geq 2$): two atoms drawn from distinct complementary pairs have

$$a \wedge b = \mathbf{0} \quad (\text{meet only at the origin}) \quad \text{yet} \quad a \not\perp b,$$

so meet-zero $\neq$ orthogonal already here. MO_3 is the smallest non-distributive OML.

Definition 2.5 (OMP; concrete logic). An *orthomodular poset* (OMP) weakens Definition 2.3: joins $a \vee b$ are required only for *orthogonal* pairs. An OMP is a *concrete logic* (equivalently *set-representable*) if it embeds into $(\mathcal{P}(X), \subseteq, X \setminus (-))$ for some set X , preserving existing orthogonal joins — i.e. its propositions can be modelled as actual *sets of outcomes*. (Concreteness is the property that separates the open frontier from the settled cases in §5, so it earns a name now.)

Remark 2.6 (Concreteness does not close the gap). A set-representable OMP needs only closure under complement and *disjoint* union [3]; intersection-closure would force a field of sets, hence Boolean. The lattice meet $a \wedge b$ is the greatest L -member inside $A \cap B$, so orthogonality ($A \cap B = \emptyset$) implies meet-zero, but not conversely. Indeed MO_3 is *itself* concrete (it carries an order-determining set of two-valued states; Gudder [15]), so the paradigmatic meet-zero- $\neq$ -orthogonal example is a concrete logic. The condition that closes the gap is not concreteness but a richness/atomicity condition (meet-zero coincides with orthogonality iff every nonempty $A \cap B$ contains a nonzero L -member); the abstract form $a \wedge b = \mathbf{0} \Rightarrow a \perp b$ is Tkadlec’s *Boolean orthoposet* condition [34] (which does *not* mean Boolean algebra).

2.2 The state/meet-additive/charge ladder

Definition 2.7 (State; meet-additive state; charge-extendible). Let A be an OML. A *state* is a map $s : A \rightarrow [0, 1]$ with $s(\mathbf{1}) = 1$ that is additive on *orthogonal* pairs: $s(a \vee b) = s(a) + s(b)$ whenever $a \perp b$. (*Probability, but additivity is only guaranteed where propositions are decisively incompatible.*) Three strengthenings, differing in *which* pairs additivity is demanded on, strictly increasing in general (e.g. on MO_3 , Example 2.8):

- (1) *State* — additive on orthogonal pairs.
- (2) *Meet-additive* — additive on every *meet-zero* pair $a \wedge b = \mathbf{0}$ (binary, strictly stronger — it reaches the gap pairs of Definition 2.2). We avoid the word “valuation” here: in lattice theory it denotes the modular function $v(a) + v(b) = v(a \wedge b) + v(a \vee b)$, a different condition.
- (3) *Charge-extendible* — the n -ary condition $\sum_i s(a_i) \leq 1$ for every pairwise-meet-zero family $\{a_i\}$ (strictly stronger again). This is the *extension* condition of §3.

Example 2.8 (The ladder is strict). On MO_3 with complementary pairs $(p, p^\perp), (q, q^\perp), (r, r^\perp)$, the maximally mixed $s \equiv \frac{1}{2}$ is meet-additive (clears (2)) yet fails (3) at $\{p, q, r\}$: $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} = \frac{3}{2} > 1$. So no state on MO_3 is charge-extendible.

2.3 The McDonald–Bimbó dual space

Definition 2.9 (Dual space; representation map). The McDonald–Bimbó duality [26] assigns to an OML A a compact space

$$S_0(A) = (F(A), \subseteq, \perp_A, P(A), T),$$

where $F(A)$ is the set of *filters* of A , ordered by $\subseteq$ and carrying an orthogonality relation $\perp_A$ and a Stone topology T , and $P(A) \subseteq F(A)$ is the set of *principal* filters — the “physical points,” the realisation datum (canonical, unlike the non-canonical pure points of the Boolean case). For $a \in A$ set $h(a) = \{x \in F(A) : a \in x\}$; then h is an OML isomorphism onto the $\perp$ -stable clopens $\text{CO}(S_0(A))^\dagger$. Define $\mu(h(a)) = s(a)$. (Read $h(a)$ as “the points where a holds” and μ as the state pushed onto those sets — the open problem is whether μ survives countable operations on them.)

Remark 2.10 (The duality is finitary — the wall). The identity $h(\bigvee_n a_n) = (\bigcup_n h(a_n))^{\perp\perp}$ holds for *finite* joins but fails for countable ones: finitary OML homomorphisms need not preserve infinite suprema. This finitariness is the wall the open problem of §5 runs into. (It is a *countable*-join phenomenon, not specific to joins: since $a \mapsto a^\perp$ is an order anti-isomorphism, $\bigwedge_n a_n = (\bigvee_n a_n^\perp)^\perp$, so the failure to preserve countable meets is its De Morgan dual — the wall obstructs countable meets and joins together.) The rival OML duality of Cannon–Döring [4] is also finitary and carries no measure; we use McDonald–Bimbó because it carries $P(A)$ as explicit structure.

2.4 The Boolean engine: Stone duality

In the Boolean case, the descent argument (“ σ -additive $\Leftrightarrow$ the measure concentrates on the physical points”) runs on *Stone duality*: a Boolean event algebra embeds in the clopen algebra of its Stone space, a charge extends to a Baire measure there (Carathéodory), and σ -additivity is equivalent to concentration of that measure on the realised points [25]. That σ -additive step is realised measure-theoretically by the meagre-sets characterisation of σ -additivity (Rao–Rao [32]): the measure vanishes on meagre Baire sets, equivalently lives on the ultrafilters closed under countable intersection, which are exactly the realised points. This is the measure-theoretic face of the *Loomis–Sikorski* representation — a σ -complete Boolean algebra is a σ -tribe of sets modulo a σ -ideal — the countable-join bookkeeping that makes the equivalence go through. There is *no* OML analogue of any of this, and supplying one — or proving none exists — is the open problem of §5: the Boolean proof has an engine; the OML proof needs one and does not have it.

Remark 2.11 (Why the bridge breaks: meet-closed but not join-prime). *The slogan: in the Boolean world “realised” bundles two properties that quantum non-distributivity pulls apart.* The Boolean bridge fuses two conditions on a realised point x : being *closed under countable meets* and being *off the countable-join defect* ($x \ni \bigvee_n a_n \Rightarrow x \ni a_n$ for some n). Rao–Rao’s “vanishes on meagre sets” is exactly the coincidence of the two. In a non-distributive OML they *split*: a principal filter $x = \uparrow p$ is always closed under countable meets, yet may fail join-primeness, since $p \leq \bigvee_n a_n$ does not force $p \leq a_n$ for any n (take $a_n = \text{span}(e_n)$ in $L(H)$ and $p = \text{span}(v)$ for *any* line not aligned with a basis vector — already $v = e_1 + e_2$: $p \leq \bigvee_n a_n = H$ but $p \not\leq a_n$ for every n). Such an x is a *realised* point that sits inside the join-defect $D = h(\bigvee_n a_n) \setminus \bigcup_n h(a_n)$. Topologically $\uparrow p$ is an *isolated* point of $S_0(L(H))$, so D is non-meagre — the reverse of the Boolean case, where the defect is nowhere dense. This is the finitary wall of Remark 2.10 seen on the dual: the category route (clopens modulo the meagre ideal) chokes on the same D as the measure route, and in fact reduces to the MacNeille completion of §4.3(ii).

3 Two axes: extension and descent

The central question — *when does a state s on an OML A extend to a σ -additive measure on $S_0(A)$?* — splits into two **independent** axes that the Boolean case fuses. A state s on A faces:

	Extension axis	Descent axis
Question	Does μ extend to a finitely additive charge on the <i>full</i> Boolean clopen algebra of $S_0(A)$?	Once extended, does the measure concentrate on the physical points $P(A)$?
Governed by	the meet-zero/orthogonal gap (§2.1)	σ -additivity — needs the missing engine (§2.4)
Status	settled: Horn–Tarski / Pitowsky feasibility; finite case = decidable LP; can fail for every state.	open. <i>The descent residue.</i>

Two observations pin down the extension axis.

Proposition 3.1 (Finite case). *For finite A the extension condition is a decidable linear program (Horn–Tarski [20] / Pitowsky correlation-polytope feasibility [29]); since h preserves meets, meet-zero elements map to disjoint clopens and a charge must satisfy $\sum_i s(a_i) \leq 1$ over pairwise-meet-zero families. It can fail for every state (MO₃, Example 2.8).*

Proposition 3.2 (Infinite $L(H)$, all states). *Let $\dim H = \infty$. No state on $L(H)$ — normal or singular — extends to a charge on $S_0(L(H))$.*

Proof. (The idea: hide a copy of MO₂ inside $L(H)$ whose four atoms are all infinite-dimensional, so even singular states must charge them.) Write $H = H_0 \otimes \mathbb{C}^2$ with H_0 infinite-dimensional, and fix an orthonormal basis e, f of $\mathbb{C}^2$. Set

$$a_1 = H_0 \otimes \mathbb{C}e, \quad a_1^\perp = H_0 \otimes \mathbb{C}f, \quad a_2 = H_0 \otimes \mathbb{C}(e+f), \quad a_2^\perp = H_0 \otimes \mathbb{C}(e-f).$$

These four (infinite-dimensional) subspaces form a copy of MO₂ inside $L(H)$: $a_1 \perp a_1^\perp$ and $a_2 \perp a_2^\perp$, each pair joining to H , while all four *cross* pairs are meet-zero (distinct lines in $\mathbb{C}^2$ give $a_i \cap a_j = \mathbf{0}$) but *not* orthogonal. Orthoadditivity gives $s(a_i) + s(a_i^\perp) = s(H) = 1$ for $i = 1, 2$ — this uses only $s(\mathbf{1}) = 1$ and additivity on orthogonal pairs, so it holds for *every* state — whence $\sum s(a_i) = 2$ over the pairwise-meet-zero family $\{a_1, a_1^\perp, a_2, a_2^\perp\}$. Since h preserves meets ($h(a \wedge b) = h(a) \cap h(b)$, the filters being meet-closed), meet-zero elements map to disjoint clopens, so any charge forces $\sum s(a_i) \leq 1$. Contradiction. The construction is finite ($n = 4$) and σ -completeness of the lattice is irrelevant. $\square$

The MO₂ count is folklore (orthoadditivity plus $s(\mathbf{1}) = 1$; cf. [21]) and $\sum s(a_i) = 2$ is already state-independent in $L(\mathbb{C}^2)$. What the *infinite-dimensional* realisation buys is reach to the singular states ($s(e) = 0$ on every finite-rank e):

Atoms of MO ₂	$s(a_i) + s(a_i^\perp)$	Reaches
lines in $L(\mathbb{C}^2)$ (finite rank)	= 1 only if s charges finite rank	normal states only
$H_0 \otimes (\cdot)$, $\dim H_0 = \infty$	= 1 regardless of finite-rank behaviour	all states (sing. incl.)

Keeping each atom infinite-dimensional drops the finite-rank precondition of the line argument (Remark 3.3), and that is what closes the extension axis on $L(H)$ completely.

Remark 3.3 (An alternative argument for normal states only). A second, technique-disjoint argument reaches the normal states without the MO_2 family. If $s(e) > 0$ on some finite-dimensional e , it is positive on a 2-plane e_0 ; choosing k pairwise-non-orthogonal lines $p_1, \dots, p_k \subset e_0$ gives $2k$ distinct pairwise-meet-zero lines with $s(p_i) + s(p_i^\perp) = s(e_0)$, so a charge forces $k s(e_0) \leq 1$ for all k — impossible once $s(e_0) > 0$. Lifting s to a functional via Mackey–Gleason / Bunce–Wright [2] ($B(H)$ has no type I_2 summand) and applying the Takesaki normal/singular decomposition identifies the states it reaches — those with nonzero normal part, i.e. $s(e) > 0$ on some finite-dimensional e , including every normal (Gleason) state — and the states it misses, the purely singular ones ($s(e) = 0$ on all finite e ; e.g. ultrafilter vector states or Calkin-algebra pullbacks). Proposition 3.2 subsumes this case; the line argument is recorded because its technique is independent and because it makes precise where the singular states sit. The open problem is on the descent axis (§5).

4 What is known

The extension axis is settled — on $L(H)$ no state extends (Proposition 3.2); the descent axis turns on whether the Boolean engine of §2.4 has an OML analogue. Three things bear on that:

1. the Boolean benchmark such an analogue must match (§4.1);
2. the partial OML results, positive and obstructive (§4.2);
3. the routes already known to be blocked (§4.3).

4.1 The Boolean benchmark

(*The target an OML engine would have to hit.*) The Kelley–Vladimirov–Pták characterisation (Fremlin [12], Thm 391D) is complete: a Boolean algebra carries a strictly positive σ -additive measure iff it satisfies all three conditions below — each of which loses its meaning off the distributive world.

Boolean (KVP) condition	OML analogue
Dedekind σ -completeness	exists (σ -orthocompleteness)
weak (σ, ∞) -distributivity	none — relies on $\wedge$ distributing over $\vee$
chargeability	none — no structural characterisation on OMLs

4.2 Positive and obstructive OML results

Positive (require structure rich enough to approximate Hilbert-space geometry):

- Gleason [14] — $L(H)$, $\dim \geq 3$; σ -additivity *on the lattice*.
- Bunce–Wright [2] — JBW projection lattices; Chetcuti–Dvurečenskij [5].

Obstructive (Boolean machinery cannot be transplanted):

- Pták–Pulmannová [31] — a *finitary* condition (*subadditive*-unitality $s(a \vee b) \leq s(a) + s(b)$, no countable joins) already collapses the *lattice* to Boolean (their Thm 1); the *OMposet* version fails (Müller’s set-representable counterexample [27]).
- Navara [28] — regularity does not force σ -additivity. Pták [30] — exotic state spaces via Greechie pasting.

4.3 Three blocked routes to a σ -OML engine

The descent argument needs an OML analogue of the Boolean engine — a σ -Stone duality, or equivalently a Loomis–Sikorski representation. The three known routes are all blocked.

- (i) **RDP / effect-algebra.** Loomis–Sikorski holds for σ -MV algebras [9] and monotone σ -effect algebras *with* the Riesz Decomposition Property [10]; but a lattice effect algebra has RDP iff it is MV, and $OML \cap MV = \text{Boolean}$ (Kalmbach [21]), so the hypothesis that would buy the representation collapses the class:

$$OML + RDP \iff \text{Boolean}.$$

- (ii) **MacNeille completion.** The MacNeille completion of an OML need not be orthomodular (Harding [17]); one cannot complete to absorb countable joins. The topological version of this route — clopens of $S_0(A)$ modulo the meagre ideal — is the same completion in disguise (the regular-open algebra), and collapses non-distributivity (Remark 2.11).
- (iii) **σ -Stone duality.** None exists. McDonald–Bimbó is finitary (Remark 2.10); Freytes’ theory [13] of σ -complete OMLs is equational, with no set/tribe representation.

4.4 Prior art on point-free quantum probability

Every existing point-free or directed-context construction lands on one side of the σ -additivity-on-a-non-distributive-structure line.

Gleason tradition

Varadarajan [35], Kalmbach [21], Pták–Pulmannová [31]: σ -additive on a non-distributive OML, but real-valued on a fixed lattice — not point-free.

Döring 2009

[8] point-free on the spectral presheaf over a directed poset — but provably only *finitely additive*, on a distributive Heyting algebra.

Bohrification (HLS)

[18, 19] point-free and the internal valuation *is* σ -additive (Scott-continuous) — but factors through an internally *distributive* locale, σ -additive only per commutative context. Non-distributivity is tamed, not carried natively.

Localic valuations

Vickers [36], Simpson [33], Coquand–Spitters [6]: point-free σ -additive, but on *frames* — distributive by definition.

OML Stone dualities

McDonald–Bimbó [26] and Cannon–Döring [4]: purely structural, no measure, no σ -version.

Every entry above occupies the line on one side. The gap is their conjunction:

The descent residue — unoccupied: point-free $\times$ σ -additive $\times$ natively non-distributive $\times$ directed-system-built.

(The directed-context-yields-non-distributivity *idea* is not new — it is the shape of Bohrification and of colimit-over-Boolean-contexts generation. Novelty would lie only in the σ -additive $\times$ point-free $\times$ native combination.)

Remark 4.1 (The boundary of the negative results). Two qualifications sharpen what is and is not ruled out. (i) *No impossibility theorem* covers the *concrete* class: the known no-go results are finite or two-valued, and the one positive occupant $L(H)$ +Gleason is *non-concrete* (Kochen–Specker [22], $\dim \geq 3$: $L(H)$ admits no two-valued states at all, a fortiori none order-determining), so concreteness is the qualifier on which the open frontier turns. (ii) *The absence of a σ -Loomis–Sikorski* is visible in the dualities themselves: both take infinite joins as a *closure*, not a union (Cannon–Döring $\text{cls}(\bigcup S_i)$; McDonald–Bimbó $(\bigcup h(a_n))^{\perp\perp}$). One should not overstate this: Gudder’s concrete logics [15] *are* set-representable non-Boolean orthoposets — but as point-ful posets, not via a σ -Loomis–Sikorski theorem.

5 The open problem

Open Problem. Does a σ -complete, concrete, non-Boolean, infinite OML admit a Loomis–Sikorski-type representation (a σ -tribe of sets modulo a σ -ideal), or a countable-join-preserving σ -Stone duality — or can one prove that none exists?

Remark 5.1 (Whether the class is inhabited). A member is *descent-relevant* only if it carries an infinite pairwise-orthogonal family (so σ -additivity exceeds finite additivity) *and* meet-zero $\neq$ orthogonal pairs. The relevant completeness is thus σ -orthocompleteness (countable orthogonal joins), weaker than the σ -completeness the Loomis–Sikorski representation needs.

The discriminating condition (element-versus-family; within one orthogonal family it is vacuous, as such a family is Boolean and there meet-zero = orthogonality):

$$(\star) \quad \exists p, \exists \{a_n\} \text{ infinite orthogonal, } p \wedge a_n = 0 \ (\forall n), \quad p \not\leq a_n \ (\forall n). \quad (2)$$

Candidate	Status vs. the four hypotheses	Concrete?	($\star$)?
MO_κ (κ inf.)	max orthogonal family = 2; descent vacuous; carries MO_2 obstruction	yes	no (vacuous)
$L(H)$, $\dim \geq 3$	skew ray P_f vs. basis $\{P_{e_n}\}$, $f = \sum c_n e_n$, $c_n \neq 0$	no (KS)	yes
Navara $\mathcal{L}$ [28]	infinite, σ -orthocomplete, rich — but stateless block	no	yes
MO_2 -swap	Navara’s $\mathcal{L}$ with block := MO_2	yes	?

The bottom row is the live case. It is concrete (sub-OMPs and products of concrete logics are concrete) and σ -orthocomplete (Navara’s closure step [28, p. 428] is state-free: “ $f_j(m) = 0$, $f_i \perp f_j \Rightarrow f_j = 0$ on the block” holds in MO_2 , where the only elements $\leq a^\perp$ are $\{0, a^\perp\}$). So the class of the Open Problem *is* inhabited; the only question left is ($\star$).

Candidate witness. MO_2 atoms $a, a^\perp, b, b^\perp$; $a \wedge b = 0$, $a \not\leq b$. With $\mathcal{F}$ mutually disjoint (Navara’s elements are $\bigvee_{C \in \mathcal{F}} v_C | C$), and MO_2 capping within-block orthogonal families at 2, an infinite orthogonal family forces infinitely many disjoint C_n :

$$a_n := a | C_n, \quad p := \bigvee_n b | C_n \quad (\in \mathcal{L}, \text{ by } \sigma\text{-orthocompleteness}). \quad (3)$$

Constancy is per-coordinate and the C_n disjoint, so p is admissible; and *in* $\mathcal{W}$: $p \wedge a_n = 0$ (on C_n , $a \wedge b = 0$; off, disjoint) and $p \not\leq a_n$ (on C_n , $a \not\leq b$). Thus ($\star$) holds *in* $\mathcal{W}$.

The sole open step ($\star$) in $\mathcal{L}$. Navara warns “the lattice operations in $\mathcal{L}$ do not coincide with those of $\mathcal{W}$ ”; orthogonality runs through the orthocomplement. The whole question is whether ($\star$) transfers:

(HINGE) In $\mathcal{L}$, $a | C \not\leq b | C$? (distinct non-complementary MO_2 atoms, same C)

(4)

(HINGE) yes $\Rightarrow p$ witnesses ($\star$); conjecture **false**; the swap is the sought object.

(HINGE) no $\Rightarrow$ swap segregates; $L(H)$ stays the lone witness.

Two riders: completeness here is σ -orthocompleteness, not σ -completeness; and $L(H)$ vs. Navara fail concreteness for different reasons (KS colouring vs. an imported stateless block). Details: the inhabitation note.

Either resolution is consequential:

Positive a relational probability theory without realisations — σ -additive probability from the entailment relation of a non-distributive OML, the non-Boolean analogue of localic measure theory.

Negative an impossibility theorem closing the entire cluster, both residues, at once.

The art constrains it from both sides: *no* impossibility theorem covers the concrete class (Remark 4.1), yet *all three* constructive routes are blocked (§4.3). What is required is not a new idea in the abstract but a representation that bypasses all three routes.

Remark 5.2 (Why $L(H)$ +Gleason does *not* already settle this — the (A)/(B) point-space equivocation). “Probability from relations, point-free” may *look* delivered by $L(H)$ +Gleason. It is not: the appearance rests on conflating two point-spaces, and *realisation* is defined as concentration on (B).

	Point-space	Gleason’s relation to it
(A)	Hilbert rays of H	<i>requires</i> them — ρ in $s = \text{tr}(\rho \cdot)$ is built from rays
(B)	MB dual filters $P(A)$	<i>removes</i> them, but only by being a representation theorem

So Gleason is the *most* point-ful result available (every lattice state $\mapsto$ the point datum ρ), and what $L(H)$ exhibits is a *separation*, not point-freeness: σ -additive measures exist on the lattice (Gleason, normal states), yet no state extends to a charge on $S_0(L(H))$ (Prop. 3.2), so a fortiori none concentrates on $P(A)$. It cannot serve as the existence proof sought — so the σ -OML representation above is the *only* candidate engine.

6 Directions

With the extension axis closed on $L(H)$ (Proposition 3.2), a single direction remains.

The general construction

Construct a Loomis–Sikorski-type representation, or a countable-join-preserving σ -Stone duality, for a concrete non-Boolean infinite σ -OML — or prove that none exists. This resolves the open problem directly, but no partial construction is currently in hand. This is the *descent*-axis residue: the obstruction is the failure of h to preserve countable joins (Remark 2.10), not the orthogonal/meet-zero gap, and so Proposition 3.2 does not reach it.

A second candidate direction — the singular case for $L(H)$ — is now *closed*, instructively. The hope: a singular state might extend where no normal state does, giving the first explicit “extends but may fail to concentrate” example the general construction lacks. It does not — Proposition 3.2 catches every state, singular included. The reduction is worth recording, since one expected the singular case to require infinitary methods.

Remark 6.1 (Finite versus countable: finite suffices). One could ask whether the obstruction to extending a singular state is realised by a *finite* or only by a *countable* pairwise-meet-zero family. The line argument of Remark 3.3 is finitary but vacuous on singular states ($s(e) = 0$ on every finite-dimensional e), which might suggest the singular obstruction needs a countable family and is therefore entangled with the descent-axis passage. It does not: the four infinite-dimensional subspaces of Proposition 3.2 are a *finite* ($n = 4$) pairwise-meet-zero family forcing $\sum_i s(a_i) = 2$, and the forcing is state-independent. So the singular case is a self-contained, finitary problem,

separable from the general construction — not governed by the finitary-to- σ passage at all. The line argument is vacuous on singular states; the MO_2 -with-infinite-dimensional-atoms argument is not, and that is the whole difference.

References

- [1] Samson Abramsky and Adam Brandenburger. The sheaf-theoretic structure of non-locality and contextuality. *New Journal of Physics*, 13:113036, 2011.
- [2] Leslie J. Bunce and J. D. Maitland Wright. The Mackey–Gleason problem. *Bulletin of the American Mathematical Society*, 26(2):288–293, 1992.
- [3] Dominika Burešová and Pavel Pták. On the set-representable orthomodular posets that are point-distinguishing. *International Journal of Theoretical Physics*, 62, 2023. Also arXiv:2401.13798.
- [4] Sarah Cannon. *The Spectral Presheaf of an Orthomodular Lattice: A Generalisation of Stone Duality to Orthomodular Lattices*. PhD thesis, University of Oxford, 2013. See also Cannon and Döring, “A generalisation of Stone duality to orthomodular lattices,” in *Contemporary Logic and Computing* (2018).
- [5] Emmanuel Chetcuti and Anatolij Dvurečenskij. On the Gleason theorem for effect algebras. *Mathematica Slovaca*, 55(3):297–308, 2005.
- [6] Thierry Coquand and Bas Spitters. Integrals and valuations. *Journal of Logic & Analysis*, 1(3):1–22, 2009.
- [7] Bruno de Finetti. *Theory of Probability*, volume 1. Wiley, 1974.
- [8] Andreas Döring. Quantum states and measures on the spectral presheaf. *Advanced Science Letters*, 2(3):291–301, 2009. arXiv:0809.4847.
- [9] Anatolij Dvurečenskij. Loomis–sikorski theorem for σ -complete MV-algebras and ℓ -groups. *Journal of the Australian Mathematical Society*, 68(2):261–277, 2000.
- [10] Anatolij Dvurečenskij. Loomis–sikorski theorem for monotone σ -complete effect algebras. *Journal of the Australian Mathematical Society*, 79(3):305–318, 2005.
- [11] Arthur Fine. Hidden variables, joint probability, and the Bell inequalities. *Physical Review Letters*, 48(5):291–295, 1982.
- [12] D. H. Fremlin. *Measure Theory, Vol. 3: Measure Algebras*. Torres Fremlin, Colchester, 2004.
- [13] Hector Freytes. An equational theory for σ -complete orthomodular lattices. *Soft Computing*, 24(14):10257–10264, 2020.
- [14] Andrew M. Gleason. Measures on the closed subspaces of a Hilbert space. *Journal of Mathematics and Mechanics*, 6(6):885–893, 1957.
- [15] Stanley P. Gudder. *Stochastic Methods in Quantum Mechanics*. North-Holland, New York, 1979.
- [16] Yukio-Pegio Gunji, Taichi Haruna, and Daisuke Uragami. Contextuality as a left adjoint: a categorical generation of orthomodular structure. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.22353*, 2026.

- [17] John Harding. Orthomodular lattices whose MacNeille completions are not orthomodular. *Order*, 8(1):93–103, 1991.
- [18] Chris Heunen, Nicolaas P. Landsman, and Bas Spitters. A topos for algebraic quantum theory. *Communications in Mathematical Physics*, 291(1):63–110, 2009. arXiv:0709.4364.
- [19] Chris Heunen, Nicolaas P. Landsman, and Bas Spitters. Bohrification. In Hans Halvorson, editor, *Deep Beauty: Understanding the Quantum World through Mathematical Innovation*, pages 271–313. Cambridge University Press, 2011. arXiv:0909.3468.
- [20] Alfred Horn and Alfred Tarski. Measures in Boolean algebras. *Transactions of the American Mathematical Society*, 64(3):467–497, 1948.
- [21] Gudrun Kalmbach. *Orthomodular Lattices*. Academic Press, 1983.
- [22] Simon Kochen and Ernst P. Specker. The problem of hidden variables in quantum mechanics. *Journal of Mathematics and Mechanics*, 17(1):59–87, 1967.
- [23] A. N. Kolmogorov. *Foundations of the Theory of Probability*. Chelsea, 1933.
- [24] Patrick S. Mahon. Distributivity and the commensurability of empirical adequacy and realism. Preprint, 2026.
- [25] Patrick S. Mahon. When does observational coherence determine probability? Preprint, 2026.
- [26] Joseph McDonald and Katalin Bimbó. A Stone-type duality for orthomodular lattices. *Mathematical Logic Quarterly*, 2023. arXiv:2208.07430.
- [27] V. Müller. Jauch–piron states on concrete quantum logics. *International Journal of Theoretical Physics*, 32(3):433–442, 1993.
- [28] Mirko Navara. Regularity and σ -additivity of states on quantum logics. *Proceedings of the American Mathematical Society*, 115(2):427–429, 1992.
- [29] Itamar Pitowsky. *Quantum Probability — Quantum Logic*, volume 321 of *Lecture Notes in Physics*. Springer, Berlin, 1989.
- [30] Pavel Pták. Exotic logics. *Colloquium Mathematicum*, 54(1):1–7, 1987.
- [31] Pavel Pták and Sylvia Pulmannová. A measure-theoretic characterization of Boolean algebras among orthomodular lattices. *Commentationes Mathematicae Universitatis Carolinae*, 35(1):205–208, 1994.
- [32] K. P. S. Bhaskara Rao and M. Bhaskara Rao. *Theory of Charges: A Study of Finitely Additive Measures*. Academic Press, New York, 1983.
- [33] Alex Simpson. Measure, randomness and sublocales. *Annals of Pure and Applied Logic*, 163(11):1642–1659, 2012.
- [34] Josef Tkadlec. Boolean orthoposets — concreteness and orthocompleteness. *Mathematica Bohemica*, 119(2):123–128, 1994.
- [35] Veeravalli S. Varadarajan. *Geometry of Quantum Theory*. Springer, New York, 2nd edition, 1985.
- [36] Steven Vickers. A localic theory of lower and upper integrals. *Mathematical Logic Quarterly*, 54(1):109–123, 2008.